Portfolio Website

Assignment 4 Presentation

Project overview and objectives

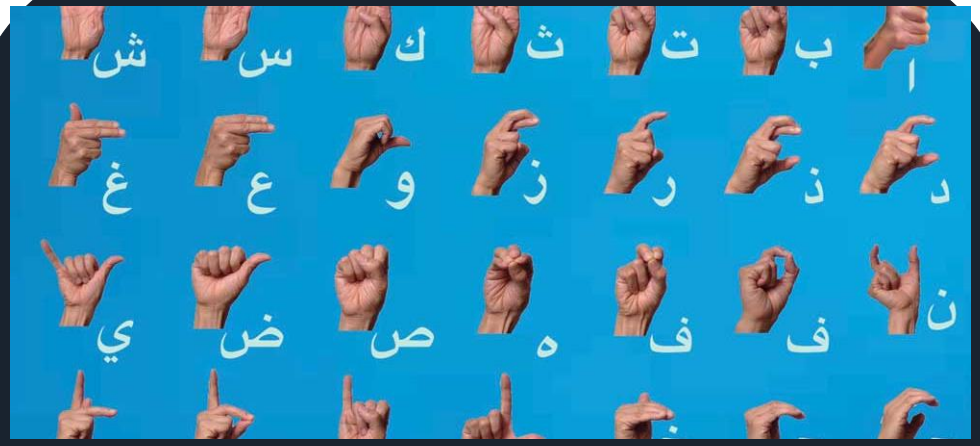
- Responsive single-page portfolio built with HTML, CSS, and vanilla JavaScript.
- Designed to showcase personal profile, projects, achievements, hobbies, and contact flow.
- Objective: combine polished UI, dynamic logic, and API-driven content in one maintainable site.

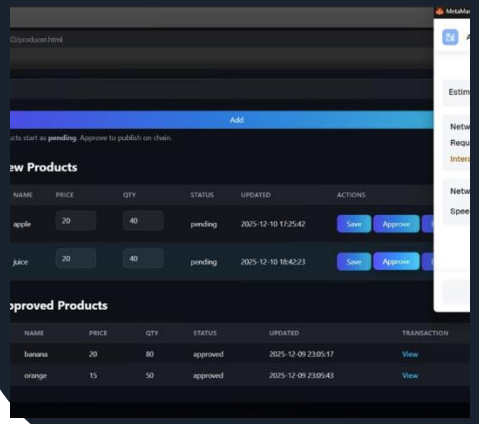
Personal motivation

I wanted the site to feel like a real digital portfolio rather than a static page, while also reflecting my interests in AI, security, and user-focused engineering.

Demo: Quick Overview of Website

Live Link: https://teal-paprenjak-f54725.netlify.app/





Suggested demo flow

- Hero section with time-based greeting and time-on-site counter.
- Theme toggle and mobile navigation behavior.
- State manager popup that saves visitor name and hidden-section preferences with local storage.
- Project filtering, sorting, expand/collapse cards, and experience-based recommendations.
- GitHub repository feed, fun-fact API block, and validated contact form feedback.

Responsive UI **Persistent state** **Live APIs**

Technical Architecture

HTML Structure

Semantic sections, form fields, details/summary cards, popup shell.

CSS Presentation

Variables, responsive layout, theme styling, animation and interaction polish.

JavaScript Behavior

State management, filtering logic, API fetches, smooth scroll, validation.

Browser APIs Persistence + Data

localStorage, GitHub API, fun-fact API, timers, media queries.

Architecture idea: keep the site lightweight and framework-free while still demonstrating richer state, logic, and API integration.

AI Integration Highlights

How AI supported the build

- Planned the workflow from HTML to CSS to JavaScript to documentation.
- Helped refine responsive layout, UI interactions, and form-validation behavior.
- Supported debugging for API integration, state persistence, and cleanup of stale references.
- Accelerated logic design for filtering, recommendations, and saved visitor preferences.

Responsible use and final ownership

- All suggestions were reviewed, modified, and tested manually.
- Final structure, copy, styling choices, and verification remained under developer control.
- AI was used as an assistant for speed and iteration, not as a replacement for understanding.

Planning | Debugging | Refinement | Documentation

Most valuable impact: faster iteration without losing manual review and accountability.

Technical Deep Dive

Challenges, tradeoffs, and lessons learned

Resolved and implemented

- Sticky-nav smooth scrolling with offset and focus handling.
- One-open-at-a-time expandable project cards.
- Persistent theme, visitor name, and section visibility using localStorage.
- Clear feedback states for loading, empty, success, and error cases.

Unresolved or not implemented

- No backend, so the contact form does not store or send real submissions.
- Live demo depends on external APIs being available at presentation time. But errors are handled gracefully

Future work and lessons

- Add a backend or service for real contact submissions.
- Cache or mock API responses for stronger reliability during demos.
- Expand the project data model with more entries and richer metadata.
- Lesson learned: combining polished UX with simple tech still requires careful state design.

Technical Deep Dive

Innovative Solutions Implemented

• Built a State Manager popup that lets visitors save their name and hide or show sections, with preferences stored using localStorage.

• Added project filtering, sorting, and experience-level recommendations so the portfolio feels interactive instead of static.

• Used expandable project cards with one-card-open logic to keep the interface clean while still showing detailed project information.

• Integrated live external content through the GitHub API and a public fun-fact API to make the site feel dynamic and connected to real data.

• Combined a theme toggle, responsive mobile navigation, animated feedback messages, and smooth scrolling to create a more polished user experience.

Lessons Learned

• A simple stack like HTML, CSS, and JavaScript can still support rich interactions when state and behavior are designed carefully.

• Good user experience depends on small details such as feedback states, responsive layouts, accessibility considerations, and smooth transitions.

• localStorage is very useful for lightweight personalization without needing a backend.

• External APIs add value, but they also require fallback handling for loading, empty, and error states.

• AI can speed up development and debugging, but manual review, testing, and refinement are still necessary to produce a strong final result.

Conclusion

Project outcomes and achievements

- Delivered a complete responsive portfolio that combines content, interactivity, and live data.
- Built a cleaner structure with dedicated css, js, docs, assets, and presentation folders.
- Documented the implementation and AI workflow clearly for review and future maintenance.

Future improvements and extensions

- Backend-powered contact handling and persistence.
- More project cards, richer filters, and analytics about visitor interests.
- Accessibility refinements, testing automation, and stronger offline fallbacks.

Responsive | Interactive | Documented | Extensible